

Bridging Domain Gaps in Visual Correspondence

From Multi-Modal Fusion to Data-Curated Motion Latents

Spencer Low · PhD Dissertation Proposal · BYU Computer Science · April 2026

Chapter 1: Cross-Modal Aerial Sensing

Chapter 2: Directed Coverage Metrics

Chapter 3: Coverage-Based Data Curation

Advisor: Ryan Farrell · Committee: Bryan Morse, David Grimsman, Porter Jenkins

Visual Correspondence: One Problem, Many Domains

Dense Correspondence

Given a point in image A, find its counterpart in image B.

Underlies: optical flow · semantic matching · 3D reconstruction · tracking · navigation

Optical Flow

Semantic Match

3D Reconstruct

Cross-Modal

The Core Challenge: Domain Shift

- Training data $\neq$ deployment data
- Sensing modality gaps (EO $\rightarrow$ SAR $\rightarrow$ IR)
- Motion statistic mismatches
- Supervision format heterogeneity
- Dense flow vs. sparse keypoints

Train on

FlyingThings (synthetic)

EO (visible light)

PointOdyssey (tracking)

SPair-71k (semantic)

Deploy to

KITTI-2015 (real driving)

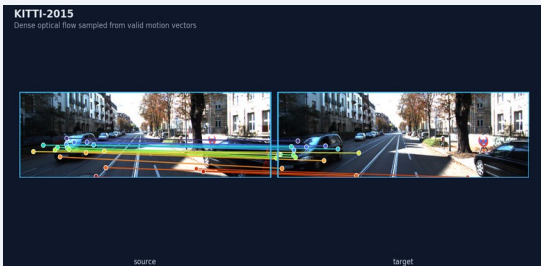
SAR (radar backscatter)

SPair-71k (semantic)

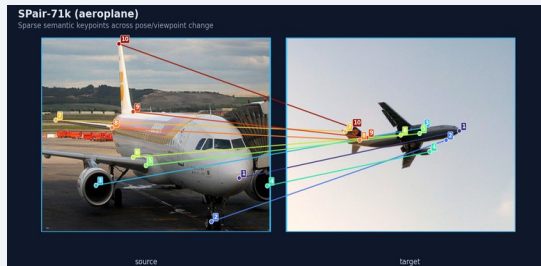
PF-PASCAL (semantic)

Correspondence Tasks Across Vision Domains

All three dissertation chapters address variants of the same fundamental challenge: find matching points across mismatched images.



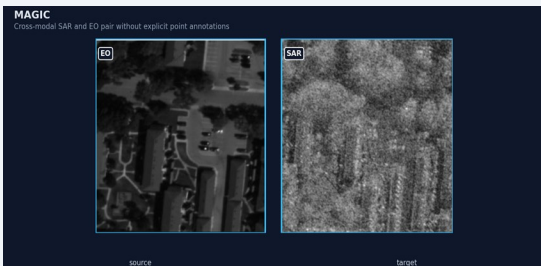
Optical Flow



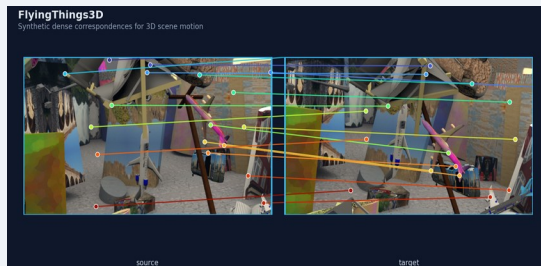
Semantic Matching



Dense Tracking



Cross-Modal



3D Scene Flow



Template Matching

Dissertation Overview

Appearance alignment between training and deployment data is a weaker predictor of correspondence transfer than is commonly assumed. The geometric structure of motion — how displacements are distributed across directions, magnitudes, and scene locations — is the more reliable and actionable axis: it explains transfer variance that appearance metrics cannot, predicts zero-shot performance across diverse benchmarks, and provides principled selection signals from whole datasets down to individual pairs.

Ch. 1

Cross-Modal Aerial Sensing

EO $\leftrightarrow$ SAR features transfer despite extreme visual disparities — appearance-domain match is not required. Progress is bottlenecked by training data scale, motivating synthetic augmentation.
Published (CVPRW 2022–2024)

Ch. 2

Directed Coverage Metrics

Non-photorealistic fractals match photorealistic baselines zero-shot — motion geometry, not appearance, is the key predictor. Directed BFV coverage separates failure modes that symmetric metrics conflate.
Under review (ECCV 2026)

Ch. 3

Coverage-Based Data Curation

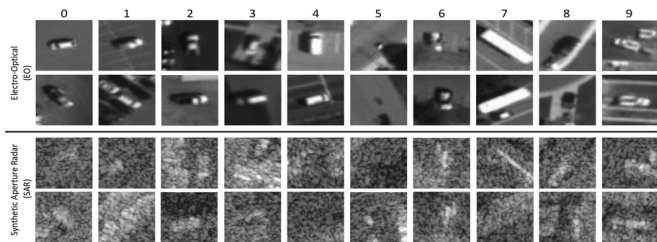
BFV motion coverage as utility function curates heterogeneous training pools — outperforms random sampling, recovers expert source routing without source labels.
In progress

Appearance alignment is increasingly saturated by pre-trained features. Motion geometry is the underutilized axis — and each chapter adds evidence.

Chapter 1: Cross-Modal Representation Learning for Aerial Imagery

Motivation: the most severe form of domain shift — different sensing physics

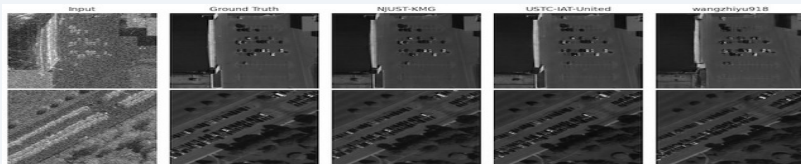
UNICORN: Co-registered EO + SAR chips (10 vehicle classes)



Key Contributions & Findings

- MAVOC/MAVIC-C: SAR+EO classification benchmark series (CVPRW 2022–2024), geographic held-out splits exposed severe location overfitting
- MAVIC-T: Multi-directional translation (SAR→EO, SAR→RGB, SAR→IR, RGB→IR); SAR→RGB substantially harder than SAR→EO
- MAGIC dataset: Aligned SAR · RGB · IR stacks for cross-modal training & evaluation
- MINNIMAN: Magnetic anomaly map prediction from EO+hyperspectral via VQ-GAN; proof-of-concept for GPS-denied navigation

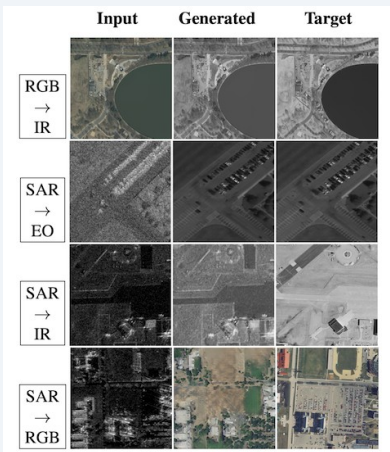
SAR→EO Translation (MAVIC-T)



🔑 Appearance similarity did not predict transfer as strongly as expected; cross-modal supervision and shared structure mattered more than looking visually closer.

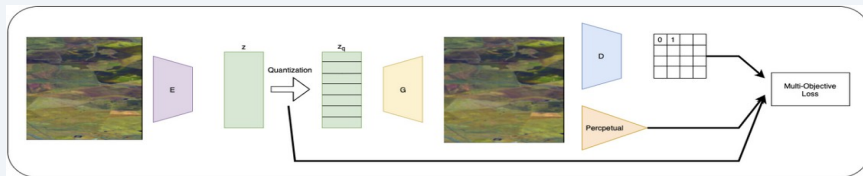
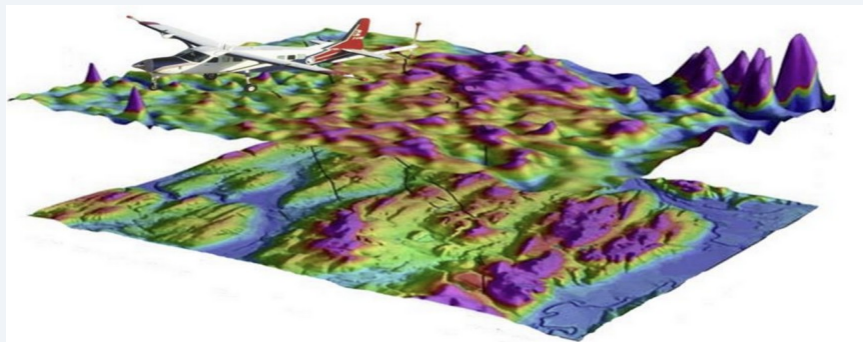
Chapter 1: MAVIC-T (Benchmark) + MINNIMAN (Cross-Domain Inference)

MAVIC-T — Open-Source Translation Benchmark



- 4 directions: SAR→EO, SAR→RGB, SAR→IR, RGB→IR · MAGIC dataset
- SAR→RGB substantially harder — larger sensing physics gap
- Metric: L1 + LPIPS + FID · Geographic disjoint splits exposed location overfitting

MINNIMAN — Magnetic Map Inference for GPS-Denied Nav



- Predicts magnetic anomaly maps from EO + hyperspectral inputs
- VQ-GAN codebook discretizes map space · teacher-student for modality changes
- Proof-of-concept: same cross-modal logic, applied to navigation signals

From Chapter 1 to Chapter 2: Why Labeled Data Is Not Enough

The Aerial Sensing Challenge

- Sensors capture at different resolutions, projection models, and ground footprints — spatial alignment is non-trivial
- Temporal co-registration requires the scene to be stable across passes — rare in practice
- MAGIC is one of the few open-source datasets spatially and temporally co-registered across SAR · RGB · IR · hyperspectral
- Despite this, scale and geographic diversity remain limited — and dense correspondence labels do not exist

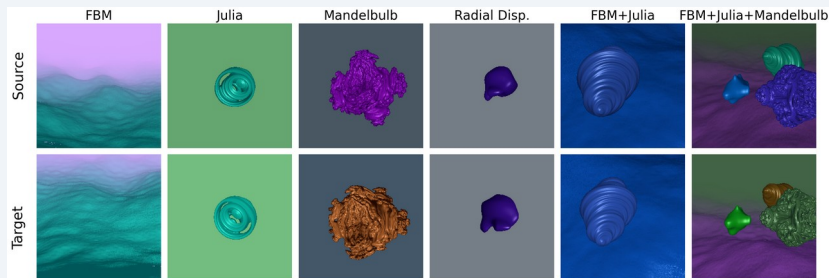
Correspondence Labels Are Expensive Everywhere

- Dense optical flow: requires calibrated stereo rigs or LiDAR depth — hardware-constrained
- Semantic keypoints: human annotators per pair — slow, expensive, domain-specific
- Labels for driving $\neq$ labels for aerial $\neq$ labels for medical — no single dataset generalizes
- The bottleneck is not modeling — it is labeled data

Chapter 2 Approach: generate unlimited labeled correspondence pairs synthetically — and ask whether controllable motion structure predicts real-world transfer

Chapter 2: SDF-Fractal3D — A Controllable Synthetic Pipeline

Intentionally non-photorealistic — yet transfers strongly zero-shot across diverse real benchmarks



Design Principles

- Asset-free, procedurally scalable — no 3D assets or rendering pipelines
- Factorized: motion sampler $\times$ appearance stage are independent
- Motion sampler: camera viewpoints + controllable zoom distribution
- Appearance: procedural textures, independent lighting & backgrounds
- Allows motion-only interventions while holding appearance fixed
- 2D Warp variant: same 3D correspondence field, warped photorealistic textures

Existing synthetic datasets require:

FlyingThings3D

Pre-rendered offline
3D asset library download required
Photo-real textures & lighting

Kubric

Pre-rendered offline
Asset pipeline download required
Realistic physics, reflections & shadows

No real imagery, no 3D assets, no photorealistic textures. Does it transfer? Let's find out.

Zero-Shot Transfer Grid: SDF-Fractal3D Competitive Despite Non-Photorealism

PCK @ $\alpha=5\%$: a keypoint prediction is correct if within 5% of the image diagonal from ground-truth. RAFT + CATs++ averaged — zero-shot, no fine-tuning on any target.

Train Set	Type	KITTI-12	KITTI-15	SPair	TSS	PF-PASCAL	PF-WILLOW	PointOd.	FlyingThings	Middlebury	SDF-Fractal3D
Sintel	Flow	94.8	91.4	10.0	44.6	27.9	30.7	59.7	73.5	53.8	26.8
FlyingThings3D	Flow	96.2	93.4	10.0	44.8	29.0	31.6	55.0	80.6	53.9	27.0
SPair-71k	Semantic	40.4	41.9	13.0	27.6	18.1	21.7	23.6	28.5	23.3	17.7
PointOdyssey	Tracking	91.2	88.9	10.5	41.4	25.6	28.2	70.4	68.9	54.1	25.6
ImageNet 2D Warp	Flow	68.5	72.7	10.0	34.4	20.5	23.9	36.4	56.3	41.1	24.2
SDF-Fractal3D	Flow	89.0	90.5	11.3	42.7	27.4	29.9	46.6	68.9	48.1	34.0
SDF-Fractal3D (2D Warp)	Flow	86.1	88.9	11.6	39.3	27.7	30.0	52.0	70.8	49.2	29.8
SDF-Fractal3D (Zoom) ★	Flow	95.7	94.6	11.0	46.3	28.4	32.0	48.8	72.3	51.6	54.1

SDF-Fractal3D (Zoom): 94.6 KITTI-15 — matches FlyingThings without real imagery

SDF-Fractal3D (Zoom): 46.3 TSS — non-photorealism doesn't prevent motion transfer

SPair-only: strong semantic (PF-PASCAL) but weak optical flow — no single source dominates

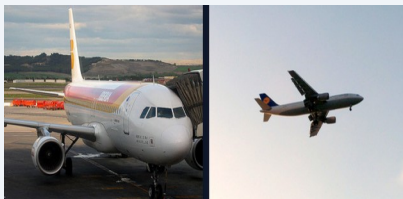
FlyingThings wins some columns, SDF-Zoom wins others — realistic rendering alone is not the determining factor

🔑 Fractals match photorealistic baselines on multiple benchmarks. Appearance is not the explanation — something else is driving transfer.

What the Training & Evaluation Datasets Look Like

SDF-Fractal3D has no real imagery — yet it just matched photorealistic baselines. Look at what the benchmarks actually look like.

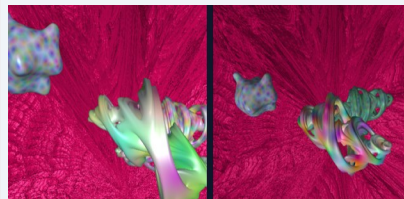
Training Sources



SPair-71k



PointOdyssey



SDF-Fractal3D



FlyingThings3D

Evaluation Targets



KITTI-2015



PF-PASCAL



PF-WILLOW



TSS (3 subsets)

🔑 Fractals look nothing like any of these — no roads, no cars, no animals. If appearance isn't the signal, what is?

Representing Datasets: Bag-of-Flow-Vectors (BFV)

Motion Descriptor

$$\mathbf{f}_{\text{flow}} = [\mathbf{x}_{\text{src}}, \mathbf{y}_{\text{src}}, \Delta x, \Delta y]$$

All components normalized by image dimensions · One 4-D sample per correspondence

- Resolution-agnostic — works across datasets with different image sizes
- Captures where motion occurs AND how objects move
- No rigid spatial grid → avoids discretization artifacts
- Physically meaningful Euclidean scale → enables ϵ -coverage radius

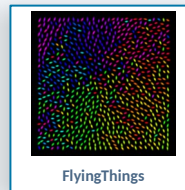
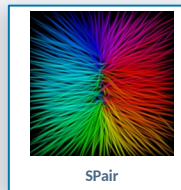
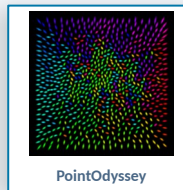
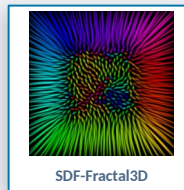
Appearance: patchwise DINOv2 embeddings projected onto unit hypersphere

Each dataset becomes a point cloud in BFV space — transferability becomes a geometric coverage problem.

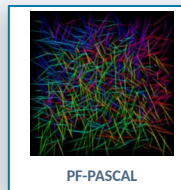
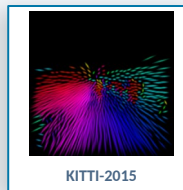
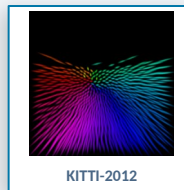
Representative BFV Splats



Training corpora



Benchmark / eval sets



Directed Coverage: An Asymmetric Diagnostic Framework

$$\epsilon\text{-Support Inclusion: } S_\epsilon(A | B) = \frac{1}{|A|} \sum_{a \in A} \mathbf{1}[\min_{b \in B} \|a - b\|_2 \leq \epsilon]$$

HOF = Histogram of
Optical Flow (angle bins)

4 predictors: $BFV S_\epsilon(Eval | Train) \cdot BFV S_\epsilon(Train | Eval) \cdot DINOv2 S_\epsilon(Eval | Train) \cdot DINOv2 S_\epsilon(Train | Eval)$

Eval $\subseteq_\epsilon$ Train

Target-Support View

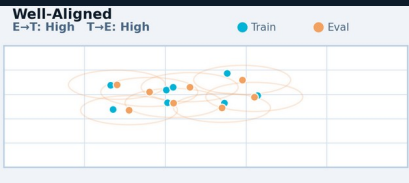
What fraction of eval BFV points have a training neighbor within ϵ ?
Low = model never encounters those motion modes $\rightarrow$ transfer fails.

Train $\subseteq_\epsilon$ Eval

Off-Target-Mass View

What fraction of training BFV points have an eval neighbor within ϵ ?
Low = training wastes capacity on off-target motion patterns.

The 4 Coverage Regimes:



Eval $\subseteq_\epsilon$ Train: High $\cdot$ Train $\subseteq_\epsilon$ Eval: High

Well-Aligned

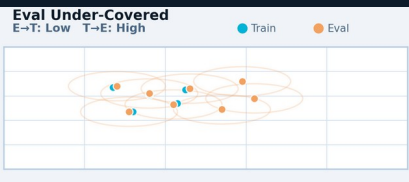
Training covers eval and is efficiently used. Best transfer outcome.



Eval $\subseteq_\epsilon$ Train: High $\cdot$ Train $\subseteq_\epsilon$ Eval: Low

Excess Train Mass

Eval is covered but training has many irrelevant motions. Wasteful but OK transfer.



Eval $\subseteq_\epsilon$ Train: Low $\cdot$ Train $\subseteq_\epsilon$ Eval: High

Eval Under-Covered

Eval requires motion modes absent from training. Transfer will fail.



Eval $\subseteq_\epsilon$ Train: Low $\cdot$ Train $\subseteq_\epsilon$ Eval: Low

Complete Mismatch

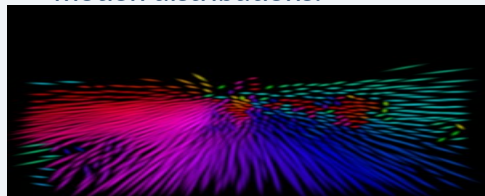
Neither direction covered. Severe domain gap.



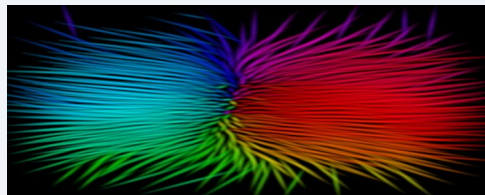
Directed support inclusion separates failure modes that KL-div and MMD conflate. KL-div is also numerically unstable (requires density estimation); ϵ -

Utility-Guided Motion Interventions: Coverage Predicts Transfer

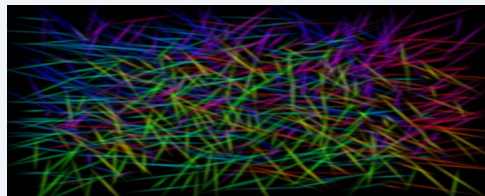
Appearance held fixed ($\|\Delta A\| \approx 0$) — only the motion sampler varies. Each intervention is designed to target specific benchmark motion distributions.



KITTI-2015



TSS



PF-PASCAL

Base / Zoom / Flip — PCK @ $\alpha=5\%$

Training Variant	Type	PCK@5%	Δ PCK	F(E→T) coverage $\uparrow$
Eval = KITTI-2015				
SDF-Fractal3D	base	90.43	+0.00	0.197
+ zoom ★	zoom	94.94	+4.51	0.653
+ flip	flip	84.72	-5.71	0.132
Eval = TSS				
SDF-Fractal3D	base	46.58	+0.00	0.061
+ zoom ★	zoom	53.42	+6.84	0.070
+ flip	flip	39.89	-6.69	0.044
Eval = PF-PASCAL				
SDF-Fractal3D	base	30.72	+0.00	0.031
+ zoom ★	zoom	34.57	+3.85	0.048
+ flip	flip	22.27	-8.44	0.029

🔑 Motion is the causal lever: zoom into target motion space → PCK rises; flip mismatch → PCK drops sharply. Appearance is constant throughout — BFV coverage is an actionable intervention signal.

Transferability Estimator: Predicting Transfer Without Retraining

Ridge-regularized linear model · predicts within-context residual performance · evaluated under 3 leakage-safe protocols

0.70

Pairwise Ranking
Accuracy (c-index)

vs. 0.50 chance baseline

$E \subseteq \varepsilon T$

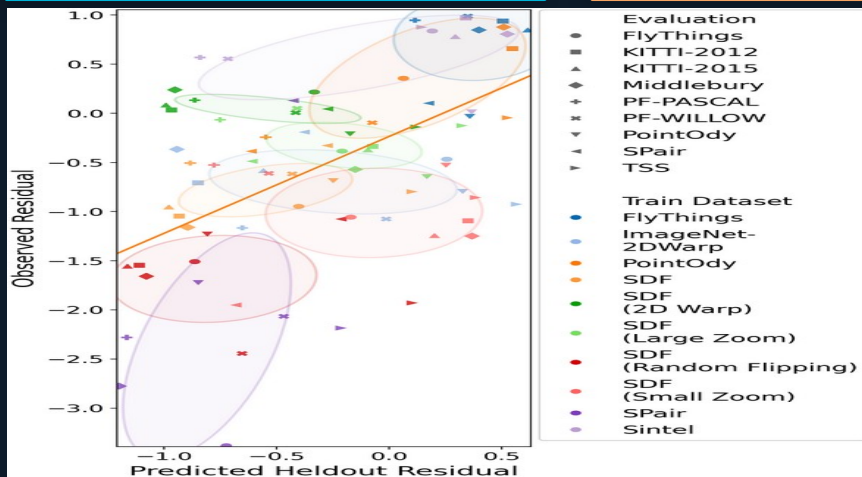
Most Consistent
Predictor

Eval subset of training — best across all 3 held-out
protocols

3

Strict Held-out
Protocols

Train, Eval, Both



Configuration	Predictors	Hold-out Train	Hold-out Eval	Hold-out Both
Symmetric (baseline)				
Appearance MMD	MMDx1	46.2%	44.3%	41.3%
Flow MMD	MMDx1	58.7%	58.7%	58.7%
Directed — single direction				
Flow (Eval→Train)	Fx1	61.7%	61.7%	61.7%
Appearance (Eval→Train)	Ax1	54.0%	58.7%	54.6%
Directed — bidirectional				
Flow, bidirectional	Fx2	65.4%	65.6%	65.5%
Appearance, bidirectional	Ax2	63.5%	63.9%	61.9%
Best model				
Flow + Appearance bidir. ★	Fx2+Ax2	70.1%	69.8%	69.4%

Chapter 2 Summary & Bridge to Chapter 3

Contributions (ECCV 2026, under review)

- BFV motion descriptor: resolution-agnostic 4D representation in Euclidean space
- Directed coverage ($\text{Eval} \subseteq \epsilon \text{ Train}$, $\text{Train} \subseteq \epsilon \text{ Eval}$): separates missing support from off-target mass — symmetric MMD cannot
- SDF-Fractal3D: non-photorealistic synthetic pipeline; motion structure alone drives transfer
- Transferability estimator: 0.70 pairwise ranking accuracy across 3 strict held-out protocols
- Diagnostics support intervention — same signal drives Chapter 3 curation

Bridge to Chapter 3

Ch. 2 asks at the dataset level:

"Does dataset A transfer better than B to target T?"

Ch. 3 asks at the pair level:

"Which specific training pairs from a mixed pool best support transfer to multiple targets simultaneously?"

- ClusterCov is the first probe: does BFV coverage-based selection help at all?
- GIST is the full framework: BFV ϵ -coverage utility + diversity + approximation guarantee
- $\text{Eval} \subseteq \epsilon \text{ Train}$ is the reward signal — measures missing target support



The diagnostic from Ch. 2 becomes the objective function in Ch. 3.

Chapter 3: Data Curation for Dense Correspondence

Which training pairs — from a single source or across many — best support transfer to target benchmarks?

Even within a single source

- PointOdyssey: 3 clips $\times$ $\sim$ 1,800 frames $\rightarrow$ $\sim$ 4M candidate pairs
- Consecutive frames share nearly identical flow statistics
- Exhaustive training is impractical — massive within-source redundancy
- ClusterCov is the first probe: does motion-space selection beat random?

Even harder across heterogeneous sources

- Pool: PointOdyssey (98.7%) $\cdot$ SPair-71k (1.2%) $\cdot$ PF-PASCAL (0.07%)
- Dense flow vs. sparse keypoints: incomparable supervision density
- Naive pooling over-rewards densest source by volume not usefulness
- No principled cross-source budget allocation without explicit criteria

Candidate pool composition:

PointOdyssey

98.7% | $\sim$ 4.3M pairs

SPair-71k

1.2% | $\sim$ 52k pairs

PF-PASCAL

0.07% | $\sim$ 3k pairs

- ClusterCov establishes that coverage-based curation is worth doing
- GIST is needed to add guarantees, explicit diversity control, and principled heterogeneous allocation

ClusterCov: Preliminary Coverage Probe

Preliminary selector: test whether BFV coverage alone is already enough to beat random curation.

1

Cluster target BFV space

K-means on target benchmark correspondences $\rightarrow$ motion cluster centroids

2

Score candidate pairs

Each training pair scores by how many uncovered target clusters it reaches within radius ϵ

3

Greedy selection

Iteratively select highest-scoring pair, mark covered clusters, repeat to budget

4

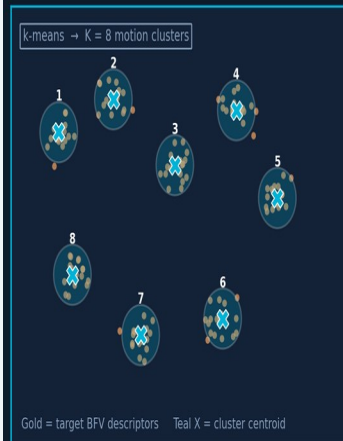
Normalize by supervision density

Divide coverage gain by # valid correspondences in pair $\rightarrow$ pragmatic probe, not a formal guarantee

Visual intuition

ClusterCov: Cluster Target Motion, Score Uncovered Modes, Greedily Build Coverage

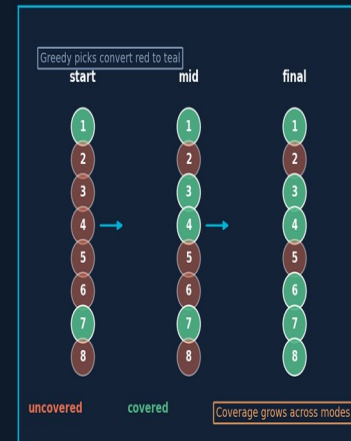
1. Cluster Target BFV Space



2. Score Candidate Pairs



3. Greedy Selection Covers Modes



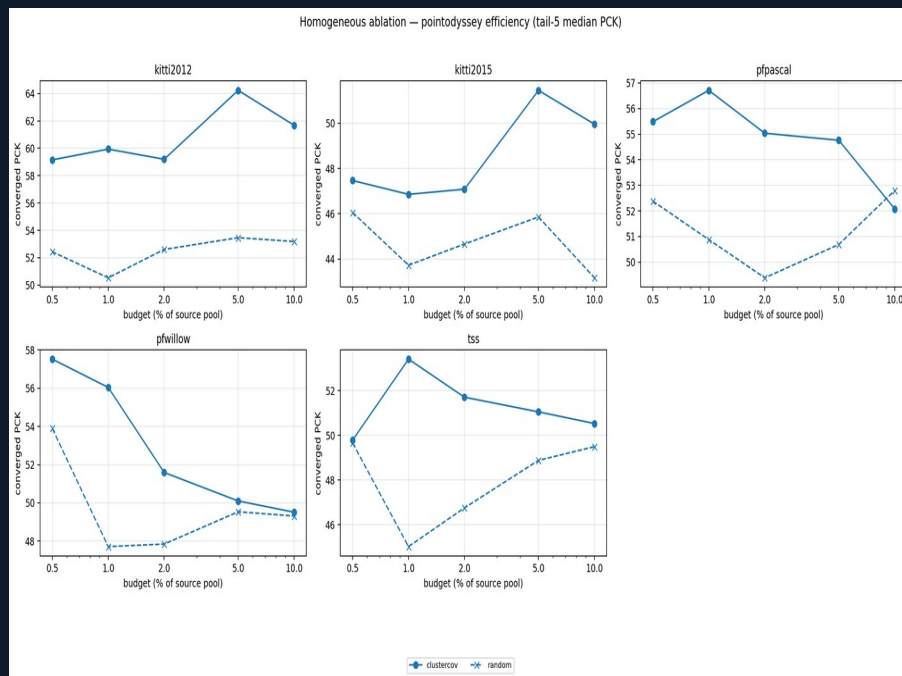
● Target BFV descriptors X Target cluster centroid ● Dense pair ■ Sparse pair

Cluster target motion modes, score new coverage, then grow support across modes greedily.

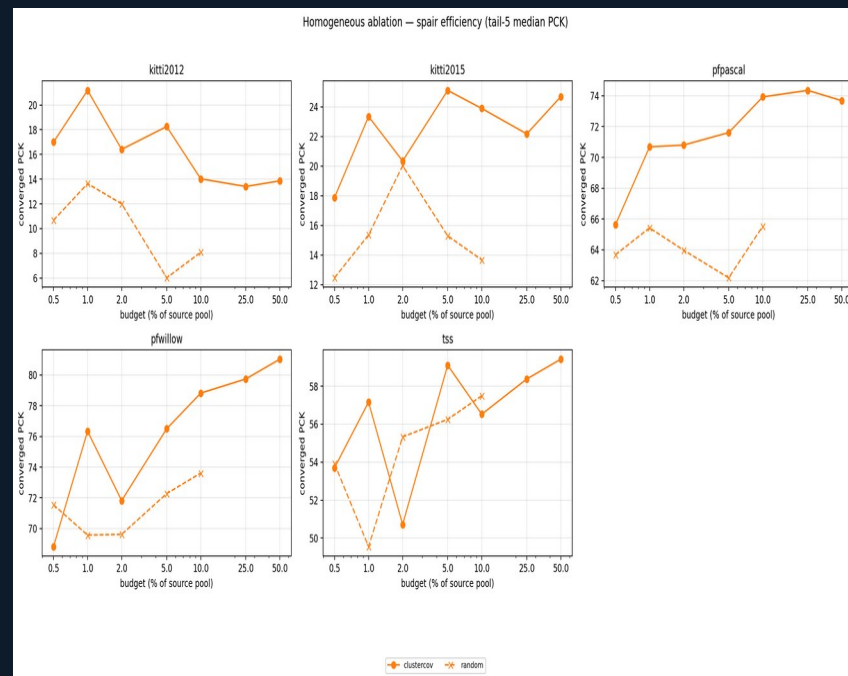
Source Ablations: ClusterCov vs. Random Within Each Source

ClusterCov outperforms random at matched budgets even within a single source — motion-aware selection is sample-efficient · PCK @ $\alpha=10\%$

PointOdyssey pool

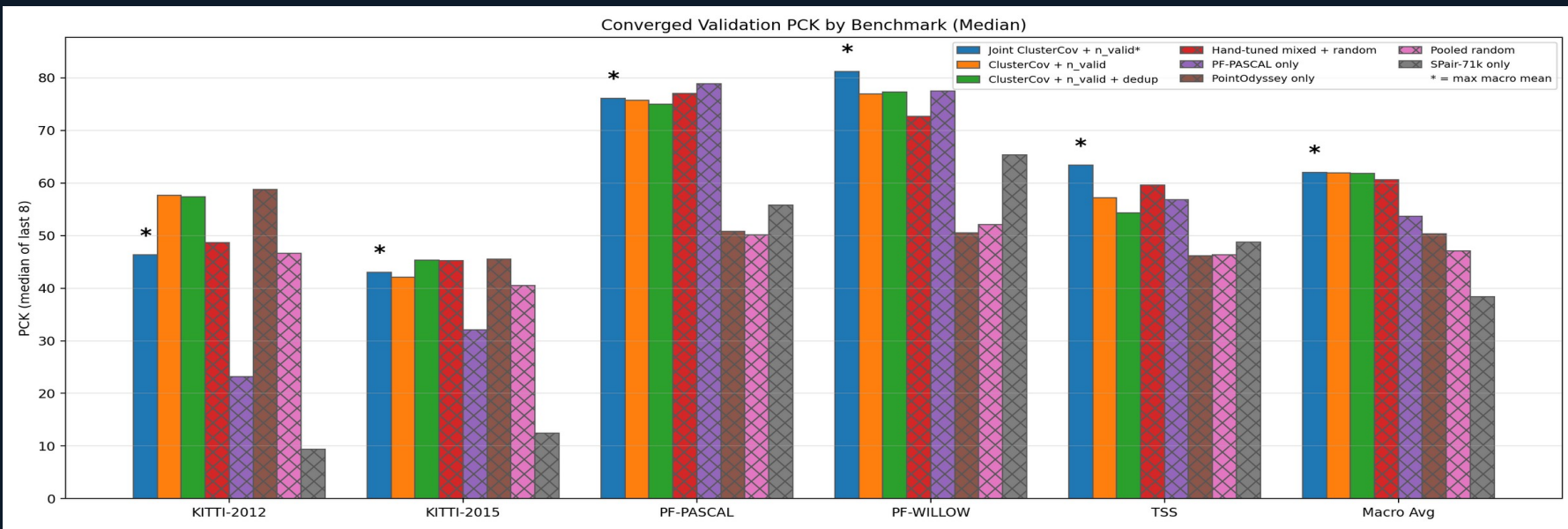


SPair pool



Counterintuitive: BFV coverage beats random on SPair semantic benchmarks — motion geometry encodes cross-domain compatibility even for keypoint data.

Preliminary Results: Converged PCK @ $\alpha=10\%$ Across All Benchmarks



What the results show:

- Joint ClusterCov + n_valid leads on TSS and is competitive across all 5 benchmarks
- Single-source baselines (PF-PASCAL-only, PointOdyssey-only) confirm strong Pareto tradeoff
- Hand-tuned mixed baseline competitive on semantic — but requires manual source proportions
- Pooled random substantially below all ClusterCov variants — selection matters

Multi-Target Selector: Automatic Source Routing

Deduplicated union of per-target ClusterCov selections. Routing is learned from motion descriptors alone — no class labels, no appearance features, no source-identity flags.

Target	PointOdyssey	SPair-71k	PF-PASCAL
Candidate pool	98.7%	1.2%	0.07%
Dedup union (22,495)	8,386 (37.3%)	13,129 (58.4%)	980 (4.4%)
KITTI-2012 (4,499)	2,546 (56.6%)	1,598 (35.5%)	355 (7.9%)
KITTI-2015 (4,499)	2,376 (52.8%)	1,924 (42.8%)	199 (4.4%)
PF-PASCAL (4,499)	1,867 (41.5%)	2,413 (53.6%)	219 (4.9%)
PF-WILLOW (4,499)	911 (20.2%)	3,527 (78.4%)	61 (1.4%)
TSS (4,499)	686 (15.2%)	3,667 (81.5%)	146 (3.2%)

Comparison: per-target routing is against a highly imbalanced candidate pool, but the selected union becomes majority semantic.

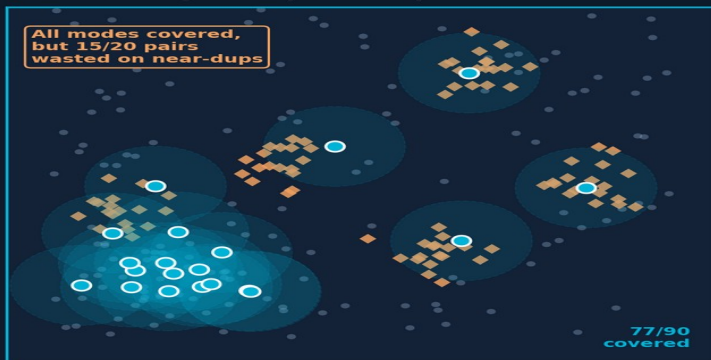
 Despite a 98.7% PointOdyssey candidate pool, the deduplicated selector shifts to 58.4% SPair. Semantic targets pull semantic sources; geometric targets pull synthetic video — emergent from motion geometry alone.

GIST: Formal Coverage + Diversity Selection for Correspondence Training Sets

ClusterCov proved coverage-based selection helps — but required k -means clustering and heuristic normalization. GIST replaces both with a formal objective: directed BFV ϵ -coverage + source-partitioned diversity, with a $(\frac{1}{2}-\eta)$ approximation guarantee that extends cleanly to heterogeneous pools.

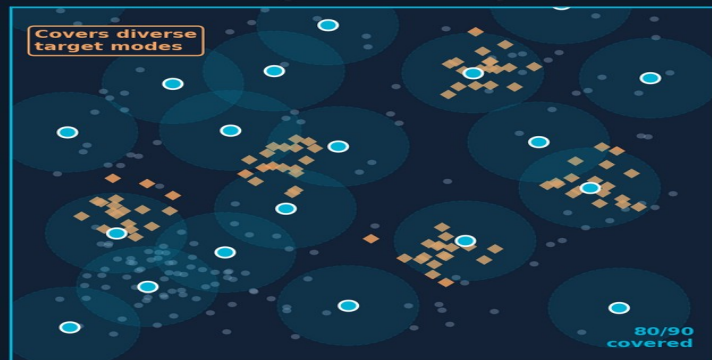
Coverage-Only vs. GIST: Why Diversity Constraints Matter

A. Coverage-Only Greedy



Budget = 20 pairs | All modes covered once, then 15 collapse into dense blob

B. GIST (Coverage + Diversity)



Budget = 20 pairs | Selected pairs spread across target modes

Target distribution (eval BFV) | Selected training pairs | Unselected pool | Coverage radius ϵ

9.07%
PF
1.2%
SPair

Heterogeneous pool composition:

~4.3M pairs (98.7%)

3 Correspondence-Specific Adaptations:

- Coverage objective $F(S) = \text{BFV } E \subseteq E \subseteq T$ coverage: fraction of target motion space covered by S within radius ϵ . Monotone submodular $\rightarrow$ greedy yields $(\frac{1}{2}-\eta)$ guarantee.
- Source-partitioned diversity: penalizes within-source redundancy independently — prevents PointOdyssey (98.7% of pool) from monopolizing budget; lets minority sources (SPair, PF-PASCAL) contribute at appropriate scale.
- Supervision-density-derived ϵ : scales ϵ with local correspondence density in target space — dense targets (KITTI flow) get small ϵ ; sparse

Unlike ClusterCov: no target-space clustering, automatic heterogeneous budget allocation, $(\frac{1}{2}-\eta)$ guarantee. Same BFV signal that diagnoses transfer now drives principled selection.

Validation Plan Across Chapters

Each chapter makes a concrete, testable claim with chapter-specific metrics and success criteria.

Ch. 1

Cross-Modal Aerial Learning

Validate MAVOC/MAVIC classification on held-out geography, MAVIC-T translation with L1 + LPIPS + FID, and MINNIMAN via map-prediction ablations.

Success: improve on strong baselines and show modality contributions are measurable.

Published / completed

Ch. 2

Directed Coverage Metrics

Validate under held-out target, held-out train set, and joint held-out protocols; compare against symmetric baselines and test controlled SDF motion interventions.

Success: ranking accuracy stays meaningfully above 0.50 and directional metrics beat symmetric ones.

Under review

Ch. 3

Coverage-Based Data Curation

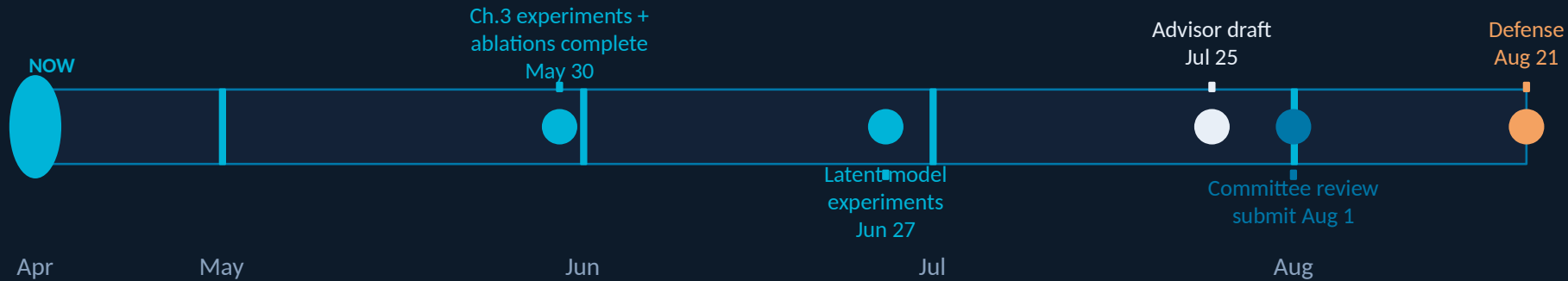
Validate pooled selection, homogeneous source ablations, joint-vs-merged allocation, source routing, GIST ablations, and lambda transfer/sensitivity.

Success: joint or normalized selector gives the strongest macro transfer profile at matched budget.

In progress

Dissertation-level validation claim: robust correspondence improves when training data is explicitly designed, diagnosed, and curated rather than treated as fixed background infrastructure.

Timeline & Status



Chapter 1	MAVOC/MAVIC series + MINNIMAN	Published (CVPRW 2022–2024)
Chapter 2	Directed coverage metrics	Under review (ECCV 2026)
Chapter 3	Coverage-based data curation	In progress (Defense Aug 21)
	— Source ablations (PointOdyssey, SPair, PF-PASCAL)	In progress (May 30)
	— GIST full framework + λ sweep	Committee review (Aug 1)
	— Masked correspondence autoencoder	Planned (stretch)

Dissertation Contributions at a Glance

Ch. 1

- MAVOC/MAVIC benchmark series + MAGIC aligned dataset
- SAR $\leftrightarrow$ EO translation across 4 modality directions
- MINNIMAN: cross-modal magnetic map inference

Ch. 2

- BFV: resolution-agnostic 4D motion descriptor
- Directed coverage ($E \subseteq \epsilon T$, $T \subseteq \epsilon E$): separates failure modes symmetric metrics conflate
- SDF-Fractal3D: non-photorealistic pipeline outperforming photorealistic baselines
- Transferability estimator: 0.70 pairwise ranking accuracy, 3 held-out protocols

Ch. 3

- Coverage + diversity curation: GIST with BFV submodular utility + $(\frac{1}{2}-\eta)$ guarantee
- Source-partitioned diversity: handles heterogeneous pool without source labels
- Supervision-density-derived ϵ : removes per-target manual radius tuning
- Empirical: motion-only selector recovers expert source routing without labels
- [Stretch] Masked correspondence autoencoder for observation-invariant latents

Anticipated Questions

Q: How sensitive is the method to the normalization exponent β ?

A: β derives from target supervision density — dense targets (KITTI) $\rightarrow$ low β , sparse targets (PF-PASCAL) $\rightarrow$ high β . Principled, not hand-tuned. Sensitivity ablation planned.

Q: Does λ generalize across target benchmarks?

A: Open question. We plan calibration/deployment split experiment. If yes $\rightarrow$ offline curation. If no $\rightarrow$ report as Pareto frontier indexed by λ . Either way is a valid result.

Q: Why not use the learned MAE latent directly for selection instead of BFV?

A: MAE latent clusters by dataset identity (appearance), not motion structure — the very problem we're trying to solve. BFV is the motion-aware alternative; MAE is a downstream representation goal.

Q: Is ClusterCov contribution sufficient if GIST ablations don't show big gains?

A: ClusterCov itself already shows the core claim: subset selection substantially affects downstream transfer. GIST adds formal guarantees and handles heterogeneous pools — important even if marginal empirical gains are modest.

Core framing if pushed: the dissertation's claim is Pareto dominance across benchmarks, not beating every single-target oracle.

Thank You

*Bridging Domain Gaps in Visual Correspondence:
From Multi-Modal Fusion to Data-Curated Motion Latents*

Ch. 1 ✓ Published

Ch. 2 ✓ Under Review (ECCV)

Ch. 3 In Progress

Defense: August 21, 2026

Questions?

Spencer Low · BYU Computer Science · slowl@byu.edu